

FREE PRACTICAL GUIDE

5 MARKETING MISTAKES COSTING BUSINESSES CLIENTS



A no-fluff checklist to spot the leaks in your ads, content, visibility and follow-up, plus a 30-day plan to fix them.

FOR FOUNDERS, RETAILERS AND SERVICE BUSINESSES
Practical checks · 30-day action plan

Use this as a working document.
Tick honestly, then fix one leak at a time.

CHRI**OS**
MEDIA

START HERE

The 10-minute leak check

Tick every statement that is true today. Every unticked box shows where your next client may be getting lost.

- ☐ My offer names one clear outcome for one clear customer group.
- ☐ My ads separate audiences, locations or services instead of targeting everyone.
- ☐ My website works comfortably on a phone and loads without making people wait.
- ☐ A customer can call, message or enquire without hunting for contact details.
- ☐ My Google Business Profile (if I serve customers locally) shows accurate hours, services, photos and contact details.
- ☐ My prices, delivery area and key terms are clear where customers need them.
- ☐ My content fits my customers' real lives and seasons, not a template from somewhere else.
- ☐ I can tell which campaign or channel produced each qualified enquiry.
- ☐ I follow up quickly with a useful next step, not a generic auto-reply.
- ☐ I only use claims, reviews, data and customer details I can lawfully support.

YOUR QUICK SCORE

8–10: tighten the details · **5–7:** fix the biggest leak first · **0–4:** simplify the whole journey

1

Trying to speak to everyone

A broad message usually becomes a vague one. It names no customer, need, buying moment or reason to choose you, so nobody feels it was written for them.

WARNING SIGNS

- One campaign covers every service, customer type and location.
- Your opening line could belong to any competitor.
- Clicks come in, but enquiries are low-fit or price-only.

FIX THIS FIRST

- Choose one priority customer and one outcome per campaign.
- Split campaigns by intent, service or area when the data supports it.
- Write in the language your customers actually use.

DO THIS NOW

Complete this sentence: "We help [specific customer] achieve [clear outcome] without [main frustration]."

2

Paying for attention before earning trust

People choosing between unfamiliar businesses look for proof you are real, reachable and relevant. Missing details create doubt before your sales message has a chance to work.

! WARNING SIGNS

- Hours, service area or contact details differ across channels.
- Your Google Business Profile or key listings are incomplete or out of date.
- Reviews and examples are generic or disconnected from the offer.

✓ FIX THIS FIRST

- Keep your name, phone, hours and service area consistent everywhere.
- Add current photos, specific services and an honest description to your listings.
- Ask real customers for specific reviews. Never buy, script or invent them.

DO THIS NOW

Look up your business from a customer's phone. Can they understand, trust and contact you in 30 seconds?

3

Sending mobile clicks into a dead end

Most buying journeys now happen on a phone: from social or search to a website, call or message. Every extra step gives a ready buyer a reason to leave.

! WARNING SIGNS

- The ad lands on a generic homepage instead of the promised offer.
- The next step is hidden, slow, broken or asks for too much.
- Messages get a vague reply with no useful question, time or booking option.

✓ FIX THIS FIRST

- Match each ad to one focused page or conversation.
- Offer one primary next step: call, message, book or enquire.
- Prepare a human follow-up that confirms the need, timing and next step.

DO THIS NOW

Tap through your own ad journey on mobile data. Count the seconds and taps from first click to a confirmed next step.

4

Running the same content all year

Generic content misses the moments that change what your customers want. Relevance comes from timing, context and useful detail.

! WARNING SIGNS

- The same creative runs through holidays, quiet months and peak seasons.
- Offers go live too late for customers to plan or compare.
- Seasonal moments are used as decoration without adapting the offer.

✓ FIX THIS FIRST

- Plan your key moments 6–8 weeks ahead.
- Adapt hours, delivery expectations, tone and creative to the real context.
- Keep a useful always-on layer so the brand doesn't vanish between campaigns.

DO THIS NOW

List the next three moments that genuinely change your customers' intent or your operations. Ignore the rest.

5

Optimising for clicks instead of clients

Reach and clicks can look busy while revenue stays flat. The useful question is not “Did people engage?” but “Did the right people take the next step, and what happened after?”

! WARNING SIGNS

- Reports stop at views, clicks or follower growth.
- Leads are counted without checking quality, booked calls or sales.
- Customer data, consent and promotional claims are handled casually.

✓ FIX THIS FIRST

- Define one commercial goal and the qualified action that leads to it.
- Track source → enquiry → qualified lead → sale, even in a simple weekly sheet.
- Use only supportable claims and follow the data rules that apply to you.

DO THIS NOW

For every unit of currency you spend, can you show how many qualified enquiries, booked calls and sales followed?

One focused month beats another month of random posting

Give every action one owner, one deadline and one measure. Keep the plan small enough to finish.

WEEK 1 • CLARITY

- ☐ Choose one priority customer, offer and outcome.
- ☐ Write one plain-language value proposition.
- ☐ Correct your business details across your main channels.

WEEK 2 • JOURNEY

- ☐ Test the website and enquiry path on a phone.
- ☐ Create one focused destination for the priority offer.
- ☐ Prepare a useful message or email follow-up.

WEEK 3 • CAMPAIGN

- ☐ Build one audience, message and offer combination.
- ☐ Set a test budget you can afford to learn from.
- ☐ Check creative, claims and data handling before launch.

WEEK 4 • LEARNING

- ☐ Review qualified enquiries, not just clicks.
- ☐ Record objections and questions from real conversations.
- ☐ Keep, change or stop based on evidence, not instinct.

ONE CLEAR OFFER → ONE CLEAR NEXT STEP → ONE WEEKLY REVIEW

Don't scale spend until the customer journey works and lead quality is visible.

Want a second pair of eyes?

Book a free brand audit

We'll review your positioning, customer journey and next best action. You'll leave with at least one clear, usable idea and a written one-page summary. No pitch, no obligation.

chrizosmedia.com

Useful references

Google Business Profile

Guidelines for representing your business
support.google.com/business/answer/3038177

Meta advertising standards

Rules for ads on Facebook and Instagram
transparency.meta.com/policies/ad-standards

Your local regulator

Advertising, consumer protection and data protection rules where you trade

IMPORTANT

Rules, platform policies and dates change. Check the latest official guidance before publishing regulated, promotional or data-driven campaigns. This guide is general marketing information, not legal advice or a promise of results.